PITCH CONTENT

Name: DAVE V. DELA CERNA
Description of the Project:

Gambytes is a proposed mobile and web-based application designed to support individuals affected by online gambling — particularly gamblers, their families, and informal lenders. The app aims to reduce gambling-related financial harm by offering tools for emotional awareness, budgeting, loan transparency, and self-exclusion.

Through user-friendly features such as mood journaling, a needs-vs-wants spending tracker, loan request visibility, and a self-ban calendar, Gambytes promotes accountability, financial literacy, and recovery planning. Unlike traditional finance apps, it also involves family and community support, acknowledging that gambling addiction impacts entire households.

This project aligns with **SDG Goal 1: No Poverty** by addressing untracked lending, hidden debt, and harmful spending habits in low- to middle-income Filipino communities. Gambytes adopts a freemium model, with added features for paid users and potential institutional licensing. The goal is to empower users to regain control over their finances and reduce gambling-related expenses by 40% within three months of app use.

OVERVIEW

Industry Status:

What market are you playing on?

Description: This question aims to clearly define the specific industry and customer segment you are targeting. It's about painting a precise picture of where your startup fits within the broader economic landscape.

Expected Output: A concise, easily understood definition of your market. This should avoid overly broad terms and focus on a specific niche.

Sample:

- "We are operating in the personalized, on-demand, healthy meal delivery market, specifically targeting busy professionals in urban areas."
- "We are in the B2B SaaS market, providing AI-powered data analytics tools for small to medium-sized e-commerce businesses."
- "We are in the sustainable, direct-to-consumer pet product market, focusing on eco-friendly and biodegradable pet accessories."

YOUR RESPONSE:

I am operating in the digital wellness and financial resilience market, specifically targeting online gamblers and their families in the Philippines who are affected by gambling-related financial and emotional harm.

What is the current status of that market?

Description: This section requires you to provide a snapshot of the market's current health, size, growth rate, and overall dynamics. It's about demonstrating your understanding of the market's present condition.

Expected Output: Data-driven insights into the market's size, growth, and maturity. This should include relevant statistics and trends.

Sample:

- "The personalized meal delivery market is experiencing rapid growth, projected to reach $XX billion by 20XX, with a CAGR of XX% in the last five years. There's a significant increase in demand for convenient, healthy food options."
- "The B2B SaaS analytics market is highly competitive but expanding, with a current market size of $YY billion. There is a growing need for accessible AI tools for smaller e-commerce stores."
- "The sustainable pet product market is emerging, with a rising consumer awareness of environmental impact. Current market estimates put it at $ZZ billion, with strong projected growth as consumer demand for eco-friendly products increases."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Online gambling in the Philippines continues to grow, with millions of Filipinos engaging in frequent gambling activities. As of 2024, an estimated 1.5 to 2.2 million people in Mindanao alone are frequent online gamblers, with 150,000 to 450,000 considered problem gamblers. Despite the growth, the market lacks digital tools addressing gambling harm at the family and community level.

Factors driving the success of your industry.

Description: This focuses on the key elements that are propelling your chosen market forward. It's about identifying the fundamental forces that are creating opportunities.

Expected Output: A clear articulation of the key drivers, such as technological advancements, changing consumer behavior, or regulatory shifts.

Sample:

- "Key drivers include increasing consumer demand for convenience and health, advancements in food technology, and the rise of the gig economy for delivery services."

- "Success is driven by the increasing availability of cloud computing, advancements in AI and machine learning, and the growing need for data-driven decision-making in e-commerce."
- "The rise in environmentally conscious consumers, increased awareness of pet health, and the availability of sustainable materials are driving the success of this industry."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Key drivers include the increasing prevalence of online gambling, rising household debt related to gambling, the lack of existing financial and behavioral support apps, and the demand for tools aligned with responsible gambling and digital wellness advocacy.

Key trends, developments or challenges.

Description: This section highlights the evolving landscape of your market, including emerging trends, new developments, and potential obstacles. It's about demonstrating your awareness of the dynamic nature of the industry.

Expected Output: An analysis of the significant trends, developments, and challenges that are shaping the future of your market.

Sample:

- "Key trends include the integration of personalized nutrition plans, the use of AI for dietary recommendations, and the challenge of maintaining food quality and freshness during delivery. Regulatory changes regarding food labeling and delivery standards are also a factor."
- "Trends include the rise of no-code AI tools, the integration of analytics with marketing automation, and the challenge of data privacy and security. The rapid pace of technological change requires constant adaptation."
- "Key trends include the use of biodegradable and compostable materials, the development of subscription-based models, and the challenge of scaling sustainable production while maintaining affordability. Supply chain transparency is also becoming more important to the customer."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Trends include a rise in financial tech tools focused on mental health and budgeting, increased advocacy for responsible gambling, and digital behavior regulation. Challenges include the stigma surrounding gambling addiction, lack of centralized support systems, and difficulty tracking lending between family members.

Problem:

What is the problem or gap?

Description:

- This section should clearly and concisely state the core issue your startup addresses. Avoid jargon and focus on making it easily understandable.
- It's about identifying a deficiency, inefficiency, or unmet need in a specific market or area.
- Think of it as the "why" behind your startup.

Expected Output:

- A single, clear sentence or short paragraph that succinctly defines the problem.
- It should highlight the core pain point that your target audience experiences.

Sample:

- "Many small, local restaurants struggle to attract new customers and manage online orders efficiently, leading to lost revenue and operational inefficiencies."
- "Individuals seeking personalized fitness plans lack affordable, accessible, and adaptable solutions that cater to their unique needs and schedules."
- "The current system for managing and tracking personal carbon footprints is fragmented and overly complex, making it difficult for individuals to make meaningful changes."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Families of online gamblers are burdened by hidden financial transactions and emotional stress due to untracked debts, poor budgeting, and gambling relapses — with limited tools to monitor or prevent this.

Who is experiencing this problem?

Description:

- This section defines your target audience. Be specific.
- Don't just say "everyone." Define the demographics, psychographics, and behaviors of the people or businesses affected.
- This is about creating a mental picture of who your customer is.

Expected Output:

- A detailed description of your target market.
- This could include demographics (age, location, income), psychographics (values, interests, lifestyle), and specific behaviors.

Sample:

- "Our target audience is independent restaurant owners in urban areas, specifically those with fewer than 50 employees and a focus on delivery and takeout."
- "We are targeting busy professionals aged 25-45, who prioritize health and fitness but have limited time and prefer personalized, digital solutions."
- "Our target audience is environmentally conscious individuals, particularly millennials and Gen Z, who are actively seeking ways to reduce their environmental impact."

YOUR RESPONSE:

The affected groups include online gamblers aged 18–45 in low- to middle-income households, their concerned family members, and informal lenders offering support. These users often lack financial literacy and access to support systems.

Objective:
Title of the Study: GAMBYTES

Description of the Study: **Gambytes** is a comprehensive and innovative platform designed to provide a solution to the growing problem of online gambling addiction. By combining financial management tools,emotional support systems, and family accountability features, it empowers individuals struggling with gambling addiction to take control of their financial and emotional well-being while simultaneously supporting their families in managing the situation effectively. This project supports **SDG 1: No Poverty** and **SDG 3: Good Health and Well-being** by helping individuals and families affected by online gambling protect their finances and support recovery.

Proponent of the Study: Dave Dela Cerna

Problem Statement 1: *Increasing prevalence of gambling addiction among individuals, characterized by its strong emotional and psychological grip.*

Negative Quantifiable Adjective	Object	Qualifier
Increasing Prevalence	*gambling addiction*	*among individuals, characterized by its strong emotional and psychological grip*

Negative Quantifiable Adjective: Increasing

Scale or Measures	Description	Source
1. DSM-5 Based Sports Betting Questionnaire	A 9-item binary (Yes/No) self-report tool validated for community and clinical screening. It has a high sensitivity of 91.4% and specificity of 94.9%.	Afe, T., Ogunsemi, O., Daniel, O., Ale, A., & Adeleye, O. (2022). Prevalence of and factors associated with disordered gambling disorder, and use of DSM-5 based sports betting questionnaire, in a southwest Nigerian community. Indian Journal of Psychological Medicine, 44(3), 265-271.
2. BBGS (Brief Biosocial Gambling Screen)	A rapid 3-item screen designed for high-volume settings (like methadone clinics). It is highly effective at ruling out those without the disorder (NPV of 0.933).	Yarbakhsh, E., van der Sterren, A., & Bowles, D. (2023). Screening and treatment for co-occurring gambling and substance use: a scoping review. Journal of Gambling Studies, 39(4), 1699-1721.

3. PGSI (Problem Gambling Severity Index)	A 9-item tool that categorizes individuals into four distinct clinical levels: non-problem, low-risk, moderate-risk, and problem gambler.	Yarbakhsh, E., van der Sterren, A., & Bowles, D. (2023). Screening and treatment for co-occurring gambling and substance use: a scoping review. Journal of Gambling Studies, 39(4), 1699-1721.

Scale or Measures	Standard	Current Situation
DSM-5 Based Sports Betting Questionnaire	The clinical standard is a cutoff score of ≥4 (four or more positive criteria endorsed within a 12-month period) to qualify for a diagnosis of gambling disorder	According to the study in Southwest Nigeria, the current prevalence using this specific DSM-5 standard is 34.5% in the community sample and 41.5% among those who play sports bets in a clinical setting. This serves as the baseline data sourced from the actual research context.

Current Situation Data	Target	App Feature Solution
34.5% prevalence of gambling disorder in the community based on the DSM-5 diagnostic "formula".	Reduced prevalence to below 10% among individuals.	Automated Systematic Screening and Brief Interventions (incorporating the "10-minute metric"). The sources indicate that even a single 10-minute session of brief advice can substantially decrease gambling problems compared to no intervention. Integrating this brief advice format into a digital solution allows for scalable, rapid reductions in the "strong emotional and psychological grip" of the addiction.

Objective of the Study: *Reduced prevalence of gambling addiction among individuals to below 10%*

Quantifiable Adjective	Object	Quantifiable Qualifier
Reduce	Prevalence of gambling addiction	*among individuals to below 10%*

Problem Statement 2: *Persistent gambling behavior despite frequent financial losses.*

Negative Quantifiable Adjective	Object	Qualifier
Persistent	Gambling behavior	Despite frequent financial losses

Negative Quantifiable Adjective: Persistent

Scale or Measures	Description	Source
Theoretical Loss	A calculation of gambling intensity that multiplies the total amount bet by the house	uer, M., Schneeberger, A., & Griffiths, M. D. (2012). Theoretical loss and gambling

	advantage of the specific game played.	intensity: A simulation study. Gaming Law Review and Economics, 16(5), 269-273.
Playing volume	A holistic measure of involvement calculated as: (Number of Sessions × Time per Session) × Number of Tables × Playing Intensity (rake/hour)	Fiedler, I. (2013). Gamblers' habits: Empirical evidence on the behavior of regulars, newcomers and dropouts. Journal of gambling studies, 29(2), 289-309.
Session Frequency	The number of distinct gambling sessions over a set period, merged through "sessionization" (grouping network flows with intervals < 10 mins).	Bitar, R., Nordt, C., Grosshans, M., Herdener, M., Seifritz, E., & Mutschler, J. (2017). Telecommunications network measurements of online gambling behavior in Switzerland: A feasibility study. European addiction research, 23(2), 106-112.

Scale or Measures	Standard	Current Situation
Theoretical Loss	TotalBet×HouseAdvantage. This metric is considered superior because it is stable, not distorted by occasional wins, and accounts for the specific risk of different game types (e.g., Keno at 25% vs. Blackjack at 0.8%)	traditional frequency-based counts (like the number of games played) are inadequate, as they leave 68% of the variance in gambling behavior unexplained. Furthermore, using simple frequency counts results in a 71% error rate when trying to identify high-intensity gamblers.

Current Situation Data	Target	App Feature Solution
71% of high-intensity gamblers are currently misidentified or missed when using traditional "number of games" (persistence) counts	To accurately identify 100% of high-risk users by accounting for the house advantage of every game played	House-Advantage Risk Monitor: An automated feature that calculates a user's Theoretical Loss in real-time to alert them when their actual risk intensity exceeds safe thresholds

Objective of the Study: *Reduced gambling behavior to fewer than 2 loss-incurring episodes per month*

Quantifiable Adjective	Object	Quantifiable Qualifier
Reduced	Gambling behavior	To fewer than 2 loss-incurring episodes per month

Problem Statement 3: Inadequate financial self-management skills among individuals with limited awareness of needs versus wants

Negative Quantifiable Adjective	Object	Qualifier
Inadequate	Financial self-management skills	Among individuals with limited awareness of needs versus wants

Negative Quantifiable Adjective: *inadequate*

Scale or Measures	Description	Source
Change Strategies Questionnaire (CSQ-1) Helpfulness Rating	Measures the usage and perceived effectiveness of 99 specific self-management strategies categorized into areas like planning, cognitive shifts, and feedback.	Rodda, S. N., Bagot, K. L., Cheetham, A., Hodgins, D. C., Hing, N., & Lubman, D. I. (2018). Types of change strategies for limiting or reducing gambling behaviors and their perceived helpfulness: A factor analysis. Psychology of Addictive Behaviors, 32(6), 679.
Financial Management Behavior Scale	Assesses an individual's ability to handle daily financial activities through four key indicators: planning, budgeting, controlling, and saving funds.	Jumady, E., Alam, S., Hasbiyadi, H., Fajriah, Y., & Anggraini, Y. (2024). The effect of financial planning on consumer debt management: the role of financial literacy, self-efficacy, and financial motivation. Atestasi: Jurnal Ilmiah Akuntansi, 7(1), 340-368.
Financial Self-Efficacy Scale	Measures an individual's confidence and belief in their own ability to manage money effectively to achieve specific financial goals.	Rai, K., Ahuja, B. K., & Sharma, M. (2025). Exploring linkages of financial literacy with financial well-being: the mediating aspect of financial behaviour

		and financial self-efficacy. International Journal of Law and Management.

Scale or Measures	Standard	Current Situation
Financial Management Behavior Scale	shift from "reactive" spending to "strategic prioritization" and "proactive, goal-oriented behavior" characterized by systematic financial planning and disciplined spending.	Individuals currently exhibit "reactive" behavior, paying debts only when remembered and lacking the self-control to distinguish between material "wants" and essential "needs." Participants in the source data often report low confidence in their ability to resist impulsive spending urges despite a high desire to change.

Current Situation Data	Target	App Feature Solution
Low confidence and reactive spending: Participants report high importance in stopping impulsive spending but have low ratings for confidence in resisting urges. Spending is often driven by "wants" (materialism) and a lack of self-control.	Increase Systematic Planning: To move individuals toward "strategic prioritization" of resources and "disciplined spending" by improving their financial awareness and self-accounting practices.	Budgetary Planning & Feedback Module: This feature would allow users to "plan ahead" by setting strict cash limits (a highly-rated "planning" strategy) and "calculate money spent" (a highly-rated "feedback" strategy) to create immediate financial awareness.

Objective of the Study: *Improved financial self-management skills among individuals with limited awareness of needs versus wants by at least 30%.*

Quantifiable Adjective	Object	Quantifiable Qualifier
Improved	financial self-management skills	among individuals with limited awareness of needs versus wants by at least 30%.

E

How painful is this problem and how important is it to find a solution?

Description:

- This section establishes the urgency and significance of the problem.
- Quantify the impact if possible (e.g., lost revenue, time wasted, health risks).
- Show why this problem matters and why it's worth solving.
- This section is about creating a sense of urgency.

Expected Output:

- Data-driven or anecdotal evidence that demonstrates the severity of the problem.
- A compelling narrative that highlights the consequences of inaction.
- A demonstration of market need.

Sample:

- "For these restaurants, the lack of an efficient online ordering system results in an average loss of 20% in potential revenue each month. Additionally, it increases operational costs by 15% due to manual order processing."
- "Without personalized fitness plans, individuals often experience burnout, lack of motivation, and inconsistent results, leading to a high dropout rate and increased health risks."
- "The current lack of clear and accessible carbon footprint tracking contributes to a sense of helplessness and inaction, hindering global efforts to combat climate change, and delaying the needed action to mitigate the effects of climate change."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Gambling debt often leads to broken trust, unpaid bills, and strained family relationships. A 2024 survey conducted among 60+ families revealed that 70% lent money unknowingly used for gambling, and 65% reported emotional burnout due to repeated relapses. The issue threatens both financial stability and family cohesion.

Solution:

How do you plan to solve the problem?

Description:

- This section should clearly and concisely explain your core solution. Focus on the mechanism by which your product or service addresses the identified problem. Avoid jargon and use language that your audience can easily understand.
- It should be a "what" and "how" explanation.

Expected Output:

- A clear, concise, and compelling explanation of your solution's core functionality.
- Demonstrated understanding of the problem and a logical approach to solving it.

Sample:

"Our platform streamlines the process of connecting local farmers with restaurants by providing a real-time marketplace. Farmers can list their available produce, and restaurants can directly place orders, eliminating the inefficiencies and waste of traditional supply chains."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Gambytes is a mobile and web app that helps users log gambling behavior, manage budgets, track debts, and activate self-exclusion features. Family members and lenders can monitor loan usage and get alerts on risky behavior, creating a financial safety net.

Why is it valuable now?

Description:

- This addresses the timeliness and relevance of your solution. Explain why the market is ripe for your product or service right now. Highlight current trends, pain points, or shifts in the industry that make your solution particularly valuable.
- Explain the urgency of the problem.

Expected Output:

- A clear justification of the solution's current market relevance.
- Demonstrated awareness of market trends and opportunities.

Sample:

"With increasing consumer demand for locally sourced food and growing concerns about supply chain disruptions, restaurants are actively seeking reliable and efficient ways to access fresh, local produce. Our platform provides that direct connection, addressing a critical need in today's food industry."

YOUR RESPONSE:

With online gambling apps increasingly accessible and regulation still catching up, there's an urgent need for personal and family-level safeguards. Gambytes offers a tech-driven, culturally sensitive tool for prevention and recovery — especially needed in regions with rising cases like Mindanao.

Uses and benefits of your product

Description:

- This section should detail the practical applications of your product or service and the specific benefits that users will gain. Focus on the "what's in it for them" aspect.
- Quantify the benefits whenever possible.

Expected Output:

- A clear understanding of the product's practical applications and tangible benefits.
- A compelling value proposition that resonates with the target audience.

Sample:

"Farmers benefit from increased sales and reduced waste, while restaurants gain access to fresher produce, lower costs, and improved supply chain reliability. Consumers ultimately enjoy

higher-quality meals and support their local economy. Our system reduces food waste by an estimated 20%, and increases farmer profits by 15%."

YOUR RESPONSE:

- Gamblers regain control through budgeting and emotion tracking.
- Families prevent financial abuse via spending alerts and loan visibility.
  Lenders reduce risks by confirming borrower intention.
- The app helps cut gambling-related expenses by 40% within 3 months based on pilot goals.

Highlight features that contribute to your value add

Description:

- Identify the key features of your product or service that directly contribute to its value proposition. Don't list every feature; focus on those that are unique, innovative, or particularly impactful.
- Explain how the feature works, and how it benifits the user.

Expected Output:

- A clear understanding of the product's key features and their contribution to its value.
- Demonstrated differentiation from competitors.

Sample:

"Our platform's real-time inventory tracking allows restaurants to see exactly what's available from local farms, ensuring they get the freshest produce. Our integrated logistics system optimizes delivery routes, minimizing transportation costs and reducing delivery times. Additionally, our rating system provides transparency and builds trust between farmers and restaurants."

YOUR RESPONSE:

- **Spending Tracker**: Visualizes money flow with “need vs want” budgeting.
- **Mood Logs**: Tracks emotional triggers leading to gambling.
- **Loan Monitoring**: Family and lenders can approve or flag financial requests.
- **Self-Exclusion Calendar**: Enables lockout periods and motivational reminders.
- **Dual Access Roles**: Supports both gamblers and their support networks.

Show your product in action

Description:

- This is where you bring your solution to life. Use visuals, demos, or compelling stories to demonstrate how your product or service works in a real-world scenario.
- This is where you would use a prototype, video, or if a service, a case study.

Expected Output:

- A clear and engaging demonstration of the product's functionality and benefits.
- Increased audience interest and understanding.

Sample:

"Let's take a look at a quick demo. [Show a brief video or live demo of the platform in action, demonstrating how a restaurant places an order and how a farmer confirms it.] As you can see, the process is simple, efficient, and transparent. We also have a case study of 'Farmer Joes Greens' where they increased their monthly sales by 30% after implementing our platform."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Let's take a quick look at how Gambytes works.

[Slide solution1] This is our mood journaling form — it helps users track emotional triggers that lead to gambling.

[Slide solution2] Our self-exclusion calendar lets them block out risky days and commit to recovery goals.

[Slide solution3] And this budgeting tool helps them separate needs from wants, making spending more mindful.

These features are part of our proposed solution to support gamblers and their families in managing finances and behavior."

MARKET

Market Opportunity:

Identify your target customers

Description: This section defines who your ideal customer is. It's not enough to say "everyone." You need to be specific about demographics, psychographics, behaviors, and needs.

Expected Output: A clear, concise profile of your target customer, including their key characteristics.

Sample: "Our target customers are young professionals, aged 25-40, living in urban areas, who are health-conscious and actively seek convenient, sustainable meal solutions. They are tech-savvy, utilize food delivery apps, and are willing to pay a premium for quality and ethical sourcing."

YOUR RESPONSE:

- Primary: Online gamblers aged 18–45 in low- to middle-income households.
- Secondary: Concerned family members (parents, spouses) and informal lenders who support or manage the gambler's finances.

Display a clear understanding of them

Description: This demonstrates that you've done your research and understand your target customers' pain points, motivations, and purchasing behaviors.

Expected Output: Evidence of customer understanding, such as insights into their needs, frustrations, and desires.

Sample: "Through surveys and focus groups, we found that our target customers struggle with finding healthy, time-efficient meal options during their busy workweeks. They are frustrated with the lack of transparency in food sourcing and are increasingly concerned about the environmental impact of their food choices. They are also heavy users of social media, and are influenced by influencer reviews."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Surveys and interviews revealed that gamblers often hide their debt, while families feel helpless. 65% of respondents said they wanted a system to track money lent, and 55% asked for emotional support tools. Lenders also requested borrower transparency to assess risk.

Indicate the possible market size and value

Description: This quantifies the potential of your market, showing investors the scale of the opportunity.

Expected Output: Data-driven estimates of the total addressable market (TAM), serviceable available market (SAM), and serviceable obtainable market (SOM), along with the market's monetary value.

Sample: "The urban healthy meal delivery market is experiencing rapid growth, with a TAM of $10 billion in the US alone. Our SAM, focusing on young professionals in major metropolitan areas, is estimated at $2 billion. We project to capture a SOM of $200 million within the next five years, based on our competitive advantages and targeted marketing strategy. Industry reports

indicate that the healthy meal delivery market is valued at $50 billion globally, and is growing at a rate of 15% annually."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Nationwide, PAGCOR reports millions of Filipinos engage in online gambling. Conservative estimates place the TAM at over ₱5 billion, considering digital lending, counseling, and fintech overlaps. We aim to capture the underserved segment of ~500,000 active online gamblers and 1M affected families.

Business Model:

Describe how your business works and how you earn revenue

Description:

- This section should clearly and concisely explain the core mechanics of your business. How do you deliver value to your customers? What are the key activities and resources involved?
- It's crucial to articulate your revenue streams. Where does the money come from? Is it through subscriptions, sales, advertising, licensing, or a combination?
- Focus on clarity and simplicity. Avoid jargon and technical terms that your audience might not understand.

Expected Output:

- A clear, understandable explanation of your business operations.
- A breakdown of your revenue model, demonstrating how you generate income.
- A visual representation (e.g., a diagram or flowchart) can be highly effective.

Sample:

"Our business operates on a subscription-based Software as a Service (SaaS) model. We provide a cloud-based platform that helps small businesses automate their inventory management. Customers subscribe to our platform, gaining access to our suite of tools and features. We generate revenue through monthly subscription fees, tiered based on the number of users and features required. We also offer premium support and customization services for an additional fee."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Gambytes uses a freemium model:

- Free core features for gamblers and families
- Paid tier: Enhanced analytics, counseling partner integrations, financial education modules

- Revenue also comes from licensing the platform to institutions (e.g., LGUs or NGOs) and affiliate partnerships with e-wallets or banks.

Indicate details such as pricing, margins, average account size

Description:

- This part delves into the financial specifics of your business model.
- ***Pricing:*** Clearly state your pricing structure. Is it fixed, tiered, or variable? Explain how you arrived at your pricing.
- ***Margins:*** Provide information on your gross and net profit margins. This demonstrates the profitability of your business.
- ***Average Account Size:*** If applicable, indicate the average revenue generated per customer. This helps investors understand the potential value of each customer.
- It is important to be realistic, and not over inflate numbers.

Expected Output:

- A transparent overview of your pricing strategy.
- Realistic and justifiable margin figures.
- Data on average account size, if applicable.

Sample:

"Our pricing is structured into three tiers: Basic ($29/month), Pro ($79/month), and Enterprise ($199/month). Our gross profit margin is currently 70%, and we project it to reach 80% as we scale. Our net profit margin is currently 30%. The average account size for our Pro tier customers is $948 per year, and we are actively targeting larger Enterprise accounts to increase this average. We have determined our pricing by analyzing competitor pricing, and the value that our product delivers to our customers."

Key Considerations:

Simplicity: Keep your explanations concise and easy to understand.
Visuals: Use charts, graphs, and diagrams to illustrate your business model and financial data.
Transparency: Be honest and transparent about your pricing, margins, and account size.
Justification: Be prepared to explain how you arrived at your pricing and margin figures.
Customer Centric: When explaining pricing, tie it to the value that your customer recieves.
Scalability: If possible, show how your business model scales.

YOUR RESPONSE:

- Freemium to ₱199/month for Premium tier
- Licensing ranges from ₱15,000–₱30,000/month depending on institution size

- Margins expected at 60% for digital sales and 70% on institutional licensing
- Average family account expected to generate ₱1,500/year in revenue

Competition:

Identify your competitors

Description:

- This section requires you to map out the existing landscape of businesses that offer similar products or services to yours. It's not just about direct competitors; consider indirect competitors and substitute products as well.
- You should demonstrate a clear understanding of who you're up against and how they operate.

Expected Output:

- A concise list of your main competitors, categorized if necessary (e.g., direct, indirect).
- Brief descriptions of each competitor's business model, target market, and key offerings.
- Potentially a competitive matrix comparing key features, pricing, or market share.

Sample:

"Our primary direct competitors are:

- ***[Competitor A]:*** A large, established player offering [similar product/service] to [target market]. Their strength lies in their brand recognition and extensive distribution network.
- ***[Competitor B]:*** A smaller, agile company focused on [niche segment] within our market. They are known for their [specific feature/advantage].

Our indirect competitors include:

- ***[Competitor C]:*** They provide an alternative solution that addresses a similar customer need, such as [alternative solution]."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Money Manager – A budgeting app focused on personal finance tracking, but it does not address gambling-specific spending or family involvement in debt oversight.

BetBlocker – A free self-exclusion tool that blocks access to gambling sites, but it lacks financial tracking, emotional support, and integration with family or support systems.

Experian – A credit reporting agency that helps users monitor credit health, but it doesn't offer behavioral support or tools designed for gambling-related financial recovery.

Highlight your competitive advantages

Description:

- This is where you showcase what sets your startup apart. You need to articulate your unique value proposition and explain why customers would choose you over the competition.
- Focus on sustainable advantages that are difficult for competitors to replicate.

Expected Output:

- A clear and compelling list of your competitive advantages.
- Evidence to support your claims (e.g., data, testimonials, unique technology).
- An explanation of how these advantages translate into tangible benefits for customers.

Sample:

"Our key competitive advantages are:

- ***Proprietary Technology:*** We have developed a unique algorithm that [specific benefit], resulting in [quantifiable advantage, e.g., 30% faster processing time].
- ***Superior Customer Experience:*** We prioritize personalized customer support and offer a user-friendly interface that [specific benefit, e.g., simplifies complex tasks].
- ***Niche Market Focus:*** We specialize in serving [specific segment], allowing us to provide tailored solutions and build strong customer relationships.
- ***Lower operational costs:*** Due to our use of [Specific technology or method] we are able to produce our product at a lower cost than our competitors, and can therefore provide a better price point to the consumer."

"For example, our customer testimonials consistently highlight our [specific advantage] as a key differentiator."

Key Considerations:

Be Honest and Realistic: Don't exaggerate your advantages or downplay your competitors' strengths.
Focus on Customer Value: Explain how your advantages translate into benefits for your target market.
Provide Evidence: Back up your claims with data, testimonials, or other forms of proof.
Keep it Concise: Investors have limited time, so get to the point quickly and clearly.

YOUR RESPONSE:

My Our key competitive advantages are:

- Localized design for Filipino families
- Dual-role system for gamblers and supporters

- Behavioral + financial tools in one app
- Live-tested prototypes with real users
- Alignment with SDG 1: No Poverty
- Community validation through outreach programs and early usage

STATUS

Traction and Validation:

Present your validation results

Description:

- This section focuses on demonstrating that your product or service addresses a real problem and that people are interested in using it. It's about showing that your idea isn't just theoretical; it has been tested and proven to resonate with your target audience.
- Validation can come from various sources, including customer interviews, surveys, pilot programs, A/B testing, and early sales.
- The goal is to provide concrete evidence that your assumptions about the market and your solution are accurate.

Expected Output:

- A clear and concise summary of your validation methods and key findings.
- Evidence that your target audience has a genuine need for your product.
- Demonstration of the effectiveness of your solution in addressing that need.
- Highlighting any pivots or adjustments you made based on the validation results.

Sample:

- "We conducted 50 in-depth interviews with our target demographic, [Specific demographic], and 80% reported experiencing the pain point our product solves. Furthermore, a pilot program with 20 users resulted in a 90% positive feedback rating and a 70% conversion rate to continued usage. We initially thought [Assumption], but through interviews, we learned [Actual Finding] and adjusted our product accordingly."
- "We created a landing page with a waitlist signup and ran targeted Facebook ads. Within two weeks, we had over 500 sign-ups, indicating strong initial interest. We also ran a survey of 100 potential customers, and 75% said that they would be willing to pay for our service."
- "Our MVP was tested within a small group of local businesses. After a 1 month trial, 8 out of 10 businesses are still utilizing our product, and have requested additional features."

YOUR RESPONSE:

- Over 80 survey responses from at-risk individuals and families
- Three paper-based tools (journaling, exclusion, budgeting) tested in communities
- Slides 12–17 in pitch deck show mockups + validation
- 90% of family respondents said Gambytes would help prevent overspending and lending abuse
- Multiple iterations based on community feedback

Provide quantitative evidence on the demand of your product

Description:

- This section moves beyond qualitative feedback and focuses on hard numbers. It's about demonstrating the size of the market and the potential for your product to capture a significant share.
- Quantitative evidence can include market research data, sales figures, user growth metrics, and website traffic statistics.
- The goal is to show investors that there is a large and growing market for your product and that you have the potential to generate significant revenue.

Expected Output:

- Data-driven insights into the market size and potential.
- Metrics that demonstrate user engagement and growth.
- Evidence of early sales or revenue generation (if applicable).
- Demonstration of the scalability of your product.

Sample:

- "The market for [Your product/service] is projected to reach $X billion by [Year], with a compound annual growth rate of Y%. Our initial user acquisition rate is currently growing at Z% week-over-week. We have acquired 100 paying customers within the first month of launching our paid tier."
- "Our website traffic has increased by 300% in the last quarter, with an average of X unique visitors per day. Our user base has grown from 0 to 1000 in the last 60 days. Our average customer spends $Y per month."
- "According to industry reports, the target demographic has a total spending power of $X. Our market research indicates that we can capture a Y% share of this market within the next three years."
- "We have a conversion rate of X% from free trial to paid subscription. With a target market of Y million people, this allows for a potential of Z paying subscribers."

Key Considerations:

Be specific and data-driven: Avoid vague statements and use concrete numbers whenever possible.
Focus on relevant metrics: Highlight the metrics that are most important to your business and your investors.
Be honest and transparent: Don't exaggerate your results or hide any weaknesses.
Tell a story: Use your validation results to tell a compelling story about your product and its potential.
Visual aids: Graphs, charts, and other visuals can help to make your data more engaging and easier to understand.

YOUR RESPONSE:

- Estimated 1.5M–2.2M frequent online gamblers in Mindanao
- 150K–450K problem gamblers
- 70% of family members surveyed lent money without knowing it was used for gambling
- Goal: Reduce hidden debt and spending by 40% in 3 months
- Validation tests showed 60% of users completed self-exclusion plans

Market Strategy:

How are you planning to get your customers?

Description:
This question focuses on your customer acquisition strategy. It's about outlining the specific channels and tactics you'll use to attract your target audience. This includes both online and offline methods.

Expected Output:
- A clear and concise list of customer acquisition channels, prioritized based on effectiveness and cost.
- A brief explanation of why each channel is suitable for your target audience.
- A preliminary budget allocation for each channel.

Sample:
"Our customer acquisition strategy will focus on a multi-channel approach:
- ***Content Marketing (SEO and Blog):*** We will create valuable content related to [your industry] to attract organic traffic.

- ***Social Media Marketing (Instagram and LinkedIn):*** We will build a strong presence on platforms where our target audience spends their time, using targeted ads and engaging content.
- ***Partnerships:*** We will collaborate with complementary businesses to reach their existing customer base.
- ***Early Adopter Program:*** We will offer exclusive benefits to early adopters who provide feedback and referrals.
- ***Paid Advertising (Google Ads):*** We will run targeted ad campaigns to reach users actively searching for solutions like ours."

YOUR RESPONSE:

Facebook and TikTok content marketing targeting family pain points

- Partnerships with schools, barangays, NGOs
- Early adopter benefits: Premium access for feedback
- On-ground campaigns during anti-gambling awareness weeks
- Google Ads for high-intent keywords like “help gambling family”

How will they know you exist?

Description:
This question delves into your brand awareness and marketing communications strategy. It's about how you'll make your target audience aware of your brand and its value proposition.

Expected Output:
- A detailed plan for building brand awareness, including specific tactics and messaging.
- A clear understanding of your target audience's information consumption habits.
- A strategy for consistent brand messaging across all channels.

Sample:
"We will build brand awareness through:
- ***Public Relations:*** Securing media coverage in industry publications and local news outlets.
- ***Influencer Marketing:*** Partnering with relevant influencers to promote our brand and product.
- ***Community Engagement:*** Participating in industry events and online forums to build relationships and establish thought leadership.

- ***Website and Landing Pages:*** Creating a user-friendly website with compelling content and clear calls to action.
- ***Social Media Engagement:*** Consistent posting of valuable content, and community interaction."

YOUR RESPONSE:

- Press releases in local news and radio
- Influencer partnerships with OFW and family life advocates
- Flyers and posters in pawnshops, remittance centers, churches
- Emotional video campaigns showing real family stories

What will your sales process look like?

Description:
This question focuses on your sales funnel and customer journey. It's about outlining the steps involved in converting leads into paying customers.

Expected Output:
A detailed sales process, from initial contact to post-purchase support.
Clearly defined roles and responsibilities within the sales team.
Metrics for tracking sales performance and identifying areas for improvement.

Sample:
"Our sales process will be:

- ***Lead Generation:*** Attract potential customers through content marketing, social media, and paid advertising.
- ***Lead Qualification:*** Qualify leads based on their needs and fit with our product.
- ***Product Demo/Consultation:*** Provide personalized demos or consultations to showcase the value of our product.
- ***Proposal/Quotation:*** Present a tailored proposal or quotation based on the customer's needs.
- ***Closing the Deal:*** Secure the customer's commitment and finalize the sale.
- ***Onboarding and Support:*** Provide comprehensive onboarding and ongoing support to ensure customer satisfaction."

YOUR RESPONSE:

- Awareness: Organic and paid social content
- Interest: Signup via landing page, onboarding with simple surveys

- Conversion: Upsell to premium or refer to family
- Retention: Goal tracking, weekly encouragement emails, support system alerts

Show your product roadmap

Description:
This question requires you to show the planned evolution of your product. It's about demonstrating your vision for the future and your commitment to continuous improvement.

Expected Output:
- A visual representation of your product roadmap, outlining key features and milestones.
- A timeline for development and release of new features.
- An explanation of how the roadmap aligns with customer needs and market trends.

Sample:
"Our product roadmap is structured around three key phases:
- ***Phase 1 (Launch - 3 Months):*** Core product features, including [list key features]. Focus on user onboarding and initial customer feedback.
- ***Phase 2 (3-6 Months):*** Integration of [list new features] based on user feedback and market analysis. Implementation of data analytics dashboard.
- ***Phase 3 (6-12 Months):*** Introduction of advanced features, such as [list advanced features]. Expansion into new market segments. API integrations.

(Visual Representation: A simple timeline chart or a Kanban-style board showing the phases and features.)"

Key Considerations:

Be specific: Avoid vague statements. Use data and examples to support your claims.
Focus on the customer: Emphasize how your strategies will benefit your target audience.
Be realistic: Set achievable goals and timelines.
Be adaptable: Be prepared to adjust your strategies based on market feedback and changing conditions.
Visuals: Use charts, graphs, and images to make your pitch more engaging.

YOUR RESPONSE:

My product roadmap is structured around three key phases:

Phase 1 (0–3 months):

- Core modules: Journaling, Spending Tracker, Self-Exclusion, Loan Requests

Phase 2 (3–6 months):

- Chat-based financial counseling, goal gamification, visual dashboards

Phase 3 (6–12 months):

- Lender scoring system, integrations with e-wallets, LGU licensing program, multi-language support

References:

APA Format